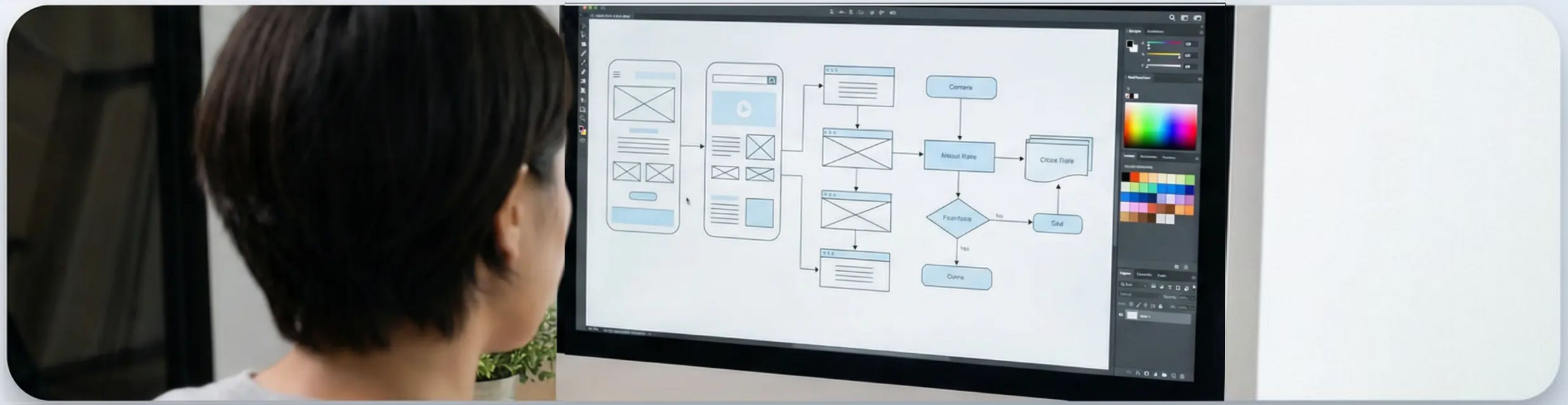
User & System Problem Identification

CSS200 Project — Academic UX Case

Navigating the academic journey shouldn't feel like being lost without a map. We are redefining the student registration experience at National Louis University.



User & System Problem Identification

1. Target User & User Goal

Undergraduate students at NLU seeking independent course planning and registration

2. Current System Problem

Fragmented information across multiple systems creating student dependency on advisors

3. Vision Statement

Transform registration from stressful process into guided, intelligent journey

4. Future-State Experience

Unified interface with automatic understanding of student needs and constraints

Target User & User Goal

Target User

Undergraduate students at National Louis University

Special focus on:

- First-year students
- International students
- Transfer students
- Students with non-linear academic paths

User Goal

I want to clearly understand what courses I need, plan my future semesters, and register confidently and independently — without stress, confusion, or delays.

Current System Problem

What the current system fails to solve:

No single place to:

- Plan future semesters
- Track degree progress
- Understand prerequisites
- Register independently

Information is fragmented across:

- Student Portal
- Academic Advisors
- Emails
- Manual documents

Resulting behavior:

High dependency on advisors (especially during peak registration)

Students rely on:

- Friends
- Group chats
- Personal spreadsheets
- Screenshots

Vision Statement

Vision Statement

NLU Academic GPS transforms course registration from a stressful, fragmented process into a guided, intelligent, and supportive journey — where the system adapts to the student, not the other way around.

Guided

Intelligent

Supportive

Next Steps & Success Metrics

Next Steps

User Research & Interviews

Low-Fidelity Wireframing

Prototyping the Visual Degree Map

Success Metrics

Reduced Advisor Dependency

Increased Registration Independence

Improved Student Satisfaction Scores

Future-State System Experience

What the Student Experiences

- One unified interface instead of multiple systems
- Automatic understanding of student needs and constraints

System Intelligence

The system automatically understands:

- Student's major(s)
- Completed courses
- Remaining requirements
- Personal constraints (work schedule, visa limits, transfer credits)

Visual Tools

The system provides:

- A visual degree map
- A clear path to graduation